LA ZHUO

Boston, MA | (617) 580 – 6684 | zhuo.la@northeastern.edu | LinkedIn | Portfolio

EDUCATION

Northeastern University Boston, MA — Sep 2023 – May 2028
Bachelor of Fine Arts, Game Design *Minor in Experience Design*
Summer Design Intensive in Denmark — May – June 2025
Relevant Coursework: Experience Design Principles, Experimental Game Design, Game Interface Design, Animation 1, Prototyping with Code, Extended Reality (XR), Critical Making for Adaptive Futures
Activities & Awards: Game Studio Club, NU Knits Club (2023-Present); NEU Business of Entertainment (2025-Present); Dean's List

SKILLS

Game Engines & Coding: Unity, Godot, JavaScript, Processing
Design: Figma, Procreate, Maya, Rhino, Blender, Adobe Illustrator, After Effects, Photoshop, InDesign, Canva, Gravity Sketch, Nomad
Project Management: GitHub, Notion, Microsoft Office Suite, Miro, Trello, Padlet, Slack
Languages: English and Chinese (Bilingual Proficiency), Japanese (professional working), Mongolian (elementary)

WORK EXPERIENCE

XR Immersive Media Lab Co-op |Northeastern University, College of Arts, Media and Design — Jul 2026 – Present
Boston, MA

- Supported PhD research and faculty-led classes through XR equipment maintenance, troubleshooting, and student training, evaluated emerging XR tools and developed interactive demonstrations to support research and teaching across disciplines.
- Built and tested Unity and Unreal Engine development workflows for Meta Quest 3 and Varjo headsets. Contributed to two mixed reality quick start guides covering Unity 6 with XR Interaction Toolkit and Meta XR SDK, verifying Build and Run workflow.
- Led workshops on XR creation tools and 360 degree video production, covering recording with Insta360 and Quest 3, editing and exporting in Premiere Pro, and headset playback. Assisted researchers and students with Rokoko motion capture setup.
- Redesigned and curated the lab yearbook and equipment catalog, directed photography, and produced RISO prints. Created posters and videos, modeled assets in Gravity Sketch and Nomad for 3D printing to promote student engagement with XR.
- Developed independent XR experiences, including a passthrough cooking interface supporting self-guided learning for children and an experimental Quest 3 game exploring appreciation of everyday moments through embodied interaction.

Game Artist & UI/UX Designer | Generate *Software Team* | Client: Board.fun — Jan 2026 – Jun 2026
Boston, MA

- Helped design a tabletop console game combining physical and digital play for children ages 6 and up in family settings.
- Designed 24 pieces of 2D environment and character concept art to support the gameplay flow for a fast-paced arcade game.
- Finalized characters in Maya for in-game controllers and 3D-printed sensor tokens, collaborating with engineers during design to optimize placement tracking. Redesigned shapes for intuitive handling by children within a 2-week sprint.
- Created UI buttons and layouts with clear hierarchy and large touch targets. Integrated assets into Unity to improve usability.

UX & Motion Designer | SCOUT *Media Studio* | Client: Default Positive — Jan 2026 – Jun 2026
Boston, MA

- Produced 2D animations and motion graphics for educational sports content for a 60k+ audience, optimizing short-form sequences for social platforms and enabling faster creator production through reusable animation assets.
- Storyboarded logo outro animations and defined timing and easing with the team, aligning motion style with brand guidelines.
- Built a hand-drawn asset library of 50+ assets and export pipeline, reducing asset retrieval time by 40% and enabling faster iteration and visually consistent short-form reels.

PROJECTS

Whisk website — Sep 2025 – Present

- Conducted interviews and user research with nine parent-child pairs to uncover safety concerns, explore learning motivations, observe cooking behaviors, and inform design decisions to create engaging and confidence-building culinary experiences.
- Designed wireframes and workflows in Figma to enable easy learning, celebrate small achievements and foster family bonding.
- Created skeuomorphism UI assets and interface elements to support a warm, experimental, child-centered experience.

Sleepy Paws Gamification App — Nov – Dec 2024

- Applied game design systems thinking and behavioral psychology principles to design reward loops and progression systems, encouraging healthy sleep habits by letting players build attachment to in-game pets they charge through regular sleep.
- Designed a mobile app in Figma through user research, wireframing, and prototyping. Created cohesive and rewarding UI and visual assets and collaborated with fellow UX designers through four prototype iterations.

Game Jams

Nest Crush | UI & Background Artist — Apr – May 2026

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Stereotypical | Game Designer & Lead Artist Jun – Jul 2024

- Pitched game ideas and developed concepts for evolving narrative stories, organized event sequences and dialogue trees.
- Designed five large-scale 2D environment artworks with navigable routes aligned to character walking cycles and created rewarding game assets that strengthened storytelling.
- Organized team workflows and backlog using Miro and Padlet. Tracked team progress using customized sprint sheets.

HashireUsagi! | Level Designer & Artist Dec 2023

- Conceived and pitched game ideas, including two sets of map tiles designs for integration into the Godot engine.
- Gained expertise in designing level layouts, including pacing, flow, and variation to maintain player interest in a puzzle game.
- Created and developed environments and additional art assets, incorporating playtest feedback into the final version.

Claustrophobia | Lead UI Artist Oct 2023

- Designed an intuitive home screen and animated buttons that aligned with the visual aesthetic while prioritizing usability.
- Developed concepts and handled UI integration in Unity, refining objects and environments through 3 iterations of feedback.